

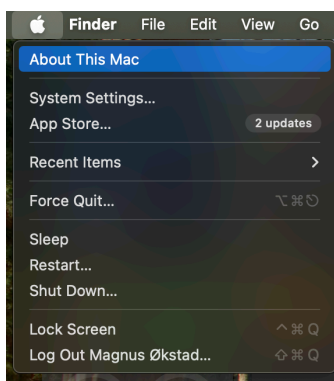
## Installing Kali on Apple Silicon Macs

This guide shows you how to install a Kali Linux virtual machine (VM) on Apple Silicon Macs.

If you get stuck, send me a screenshot of the problem at [magnuoks@ifi.uio.no](mailto:magnuoks@ifi.uio.no), or talk to me during group lectures, I'm always happy to help :)

### Check machine specifications

To check if this guide works for your machine, click the Apple logo in the top-left corner and choose [About This Mac](#).



Look for the [Chip](#) field:

- If it says [Apple M1](#), [Apple M2](#), [Apple M3](#), [Apple M4](#), etc., you have an Apple Silicon Mac and this guide applies to you.
- If it says [Intel](#), the steps are slightly different. I may create a separate guide for that later.



## Installing UTM

UTM is open-source and can be downloaded here:

<https://github.com/utmapp/UTM/releases/download/v4.7.4/UTM.dmg>

It is also available through Homebrew if you have it installed: `brew install --cask utm`

## Installing Kali

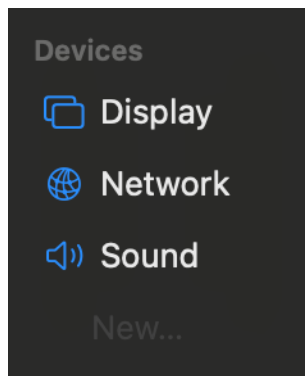
Follow the official instructions until you reach the step about adding [serial](#):

<https://www.kali.org/docs/virtualization/install-utm-guest-vm/>

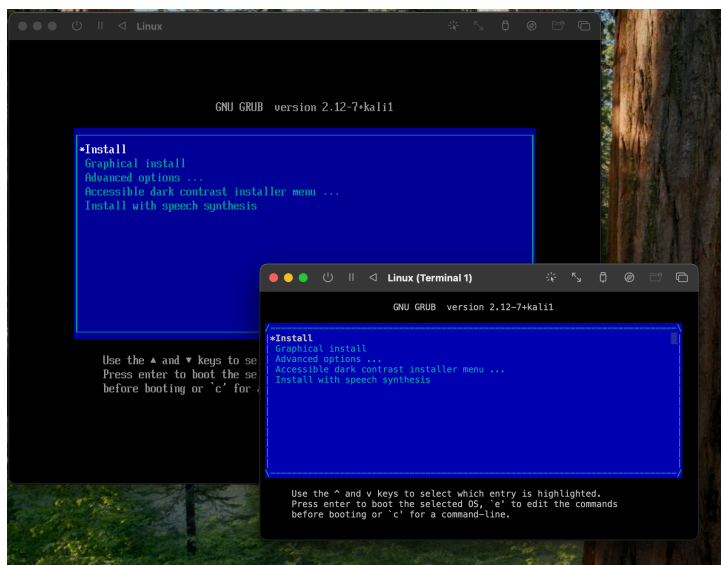
If you need the Kali ISO image, download it here:

<https://cdimage.kali.org/kali-2025.2/kali-linux-2025.2-installer-arm64.iso>

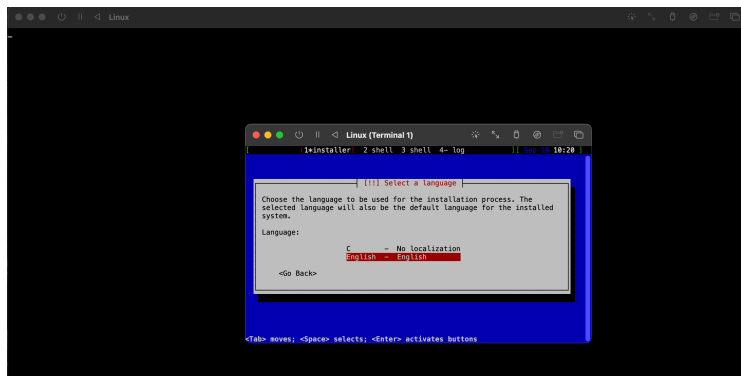
NOTE: The **serial** part is important but easy to miss. Under the **Devices** tab, click the grey **new** text and select **Serial** from the dropdown menu.



When you boot the OS after that, a new terminal window will appear underneath the main window. Minimize the main window to see it. In the terminal window, choose the **Install** option (not **Graphical Install**).

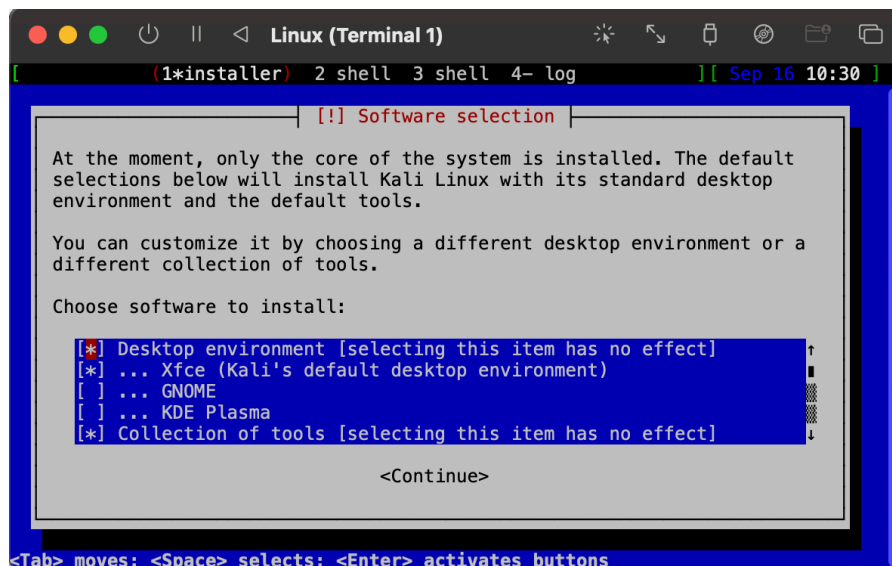


After selecting **Install**, the main window will stay black for the rest of the process.

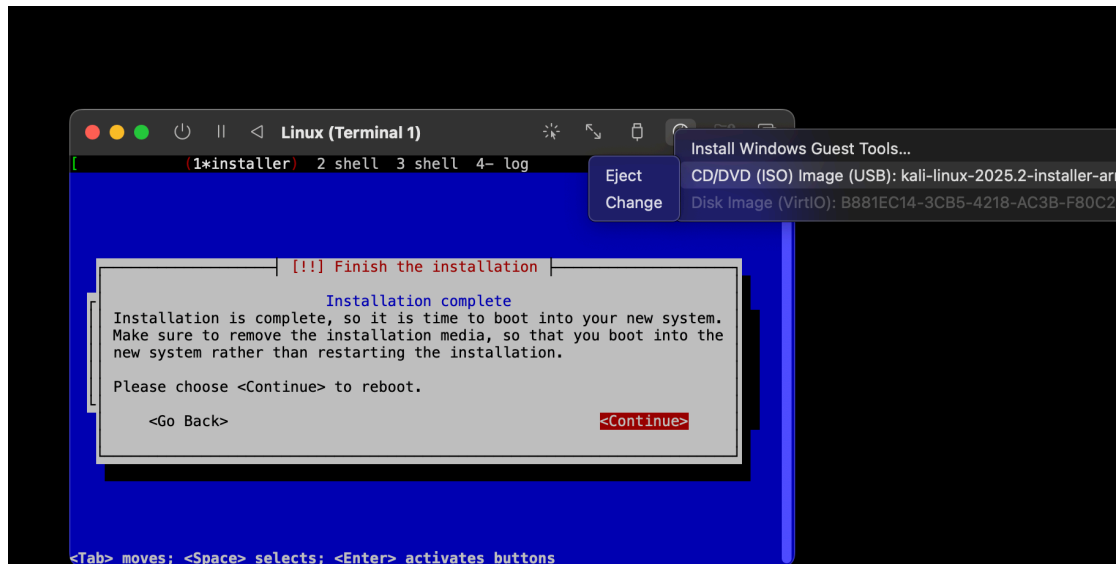


- Choose Language
  - English (recommended)
- Choose Location
  - Europe → Norway
- Choose Keymap
  - Norwegian if you use the standard Norwegian layout
  - Some differences between macOS and Linux layouts may occur
  - If this is a problem, use the shared clipboard feature
- Hostname
  - keep `kali`
- Domain Name
  - leave blank, press `Enter`
- Full Name
  - `kali`
- Username
  - `kali`
- Password
  - `kali` (default for VMs)
  - or set your own, but don't forget it
- Partitioning method
  - `Guided`
  - `All files in one partition (recommended for new users)`
  - `Finish partitioning and write to disk`
  - Write changes to disk? → `Yes`

The OS will now install. When it asks about Software Selection, keep the defaults. Press `Tab` to move to Continue, then press `Enter`.



After installation, a final `Finish the installation` screen will appear. At this point, eject the installation medium as shown below. This ensures only the installed OS boots.



**Done!**

You now have a fully functioning Kali Linux VM on your Apple Silicon Mac.